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Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist (For College Students in India)

🔐 General Safety Tips

- Use strong, unique passwords for all accounts and enable two-factor authentication (2FA).
- Do not click on suspicious links in emails, SMS, or social media messages.
- Verify unknown contacts before sharing any personal or sensitive information.
- Keep your devices updated with the latest security patches and antivirus software.
- Avoid using public Wi-Fi for logging into banking or important accounts.
- Log out from shared or public computers after use.

💳 Financial / UPI Safety Tips

- Never share your UPI PIN, OTP, or banking details with anyone.

- Always check whether a request is a "collect request" (you are paying) before entering your PIN.

- Do not scan unknown QR codes or click on unknown payment links.

- Use only official banking or trusted apps for transactions.

🚨 If You Become a Victim

- Immediately report the incident at the National Cyber Crime Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in

- Call the Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930

- Inform your bank or payment app provider without delay.

- Preserve evidence such as screenshots, messages, and transaction details.

Project report

What surprised me most while researching cybercrime was how simple and psychological many scams are, especially UPI frauds. Fraudsters often do not rely on advanced technology but instead exploit human behavior like trust, urgency, and lack of awareness. I was particularly surprised that just entering a UPI PIN in the wrong situation can instantly result in financial loss. Many victims are not careless but simply unaware of how these systems work.

As a result, one habit I will personally change is being more cautious before approving any payment request. I will always double-check whether I am sending or receiving money and avoid reacting quickly to urgent or unknown messages. Additionally, I will ensure that I never share sensitive information like OTPs or PINs, even if the request seems genuine.